



RCCG OCEANIA

Faith & Trust

FAITH OF THE HEART VS. HEAD

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

Faith is more than intellectual agreement; it is a deep trust rooted in the heart. Through biblical examples like Abraham and Thomas, we learn how true faith operates and how it can be cultivated and increased through God's word. This study will guide you in understanding and applying heart faith in your daily walk with God.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

Mark 11:22-26

John 20:25-29

Romans 4:17-21

Romans 10:10

Hebrews 11:1

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Real faith is of the heart, not the head.
- Faith can be increased by immersing in God's word.
- Faith is always present tense, as seen in Hebrews 11:1.
- Forgiveness is essential for faith to work effectively.
- Abraham exemplifies heart faith by trusting in God's promises.
- Thomas illustrates the struggle between head faith and heart faith.

INTRODUCTION

In the journey of faith, believers often encounter the challenge of distinguishing between faith that resides in the heart and mere intellectual assent. This study explores the essence of heart faith, drawing lessons from biblical figures like Abraham and Thomas, and provides practical steps to cultivate a faith that truly pleases God.

SCRIPTURE READING

- **Mark 11:22-26** — Jesus teaches about the necessity of faith and forgiveness.
- **John 20:25-29** — Thomas' journey from doubt to belief highlights head vs. heart faith.
- **Romans 4:17-21** — Abraham's unwavering faith in God's promises serves as a model.
- **Romans 10:10** — Emphasizes that faith is a matter of the heart.
- **Hebrews 11:1** — Defines faith as a present reality, not just future hope.

KEY POINTS

1. **HEART VS. HEAD FAITH** — Faith that pleases God is rooted in the heart, not just intellectual assent. Thomas initially struggled with doubt, representing head faith, but eventually moved to heart faith as he encountered the risen Jesus. In contrast, Abraham exemplified unwavering heart faith by trusting in God's promises despite circumstances.

- Reflect on areas where your faith might be more intellectual than heartfelt.
- Pray for a deeper, heart-rooted faith.
- Study the life of Abraham to understand heart faith.

Scripture: John 20:25-29 Romans 4:17-21

2. **INCREASING FAITH** — Faith can grow by consistently engaging with God's word, which nourishes and strengthens it. Just as physical exercise strengthens the body, spiritual disciplines like reading Scripture and prayer enhance faith.

- Set a daily time for reading and meditating on Scripture.
- Memorize key verses that speak to faith.
- Join a study group to discuss and grow in faith together.

Scripture: Romans 10:17

3. **PRESENT TENSE FAITH** — True faith operates in the present, as seen in Hebrews 11:1, emphasizing a current trust in God's promises. This faith is not just about future hopes but a present assurance and conviction.

- Identify areas where you need to exercise present faith.
- Journal about how you see God's promises active in your life today.
- Share testimonies of present faith with others.

Scripture: Hebrews 11:1

4. **FAITH AND FORGIVENESS** — Unforgiveness can hinder faith, as Jesus taught in Mark 11:22-26. A forgiving heart is essential for faith to work effectively, as it aligns with God's nature and commands.

- Examine your heart for any unforgiveness and seek to resolve it.
- Pray for those who have wronged you, asking God to help you forgive.
- Practice forgiveness as a daily discipline.

Scripture: Mark 11:22-26

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What distinguishes heart faith from head faith in the passages we read?
- How did Thomas' faith journey change after encountering Jesus?
- What examples of heart faith can we see in Abraham's life?

INTERPRETATION

- Why is heart faith more pleasing to God than head faith?
- How does engaging with God's word increase our faith?
- What does it mean for faith to be present tense, according to Hebrews 11:1?

APPLICATION

- In what areas of your life do you need to move from head faith to heart faith?
- How can you practically increase your faith through Scripture?
- What steps can you take to ensure unforgiveness does not hinder your faith?

PRAYER FOCUS

- Pray for a deeper understanding of heart faith over intellectual assent.
- Ask God to help you trust His promises like Abraham.
- Seek strength to forgive others, removing barriers to faith.

NEXT STEP

Reflect on your faith journey and identify areas to transition from head faith to heart faith.

CONCLUSION

Faith that pleases God is deeply rooted in the heart, characterized by trust and reliance on His promises. By examining the lives of biblical figures like Abraham and Thomas, believers can learn to cultivate a faith that transcends intellectual agreement and manifests in daily life. Through consistent engagement with God's word and practicing forgiveness, faith can grow and flourish, impacting every aspect of a believer's journey.